

■ 2.6.10 Advanced Topic: Font Specifications

When you give text to be included in graphics output, it is often possible to choose between a variety of fonts and sizes. With some *Mathematica* systems, you may also be able to make such choices for standard output from *Mathematica*.

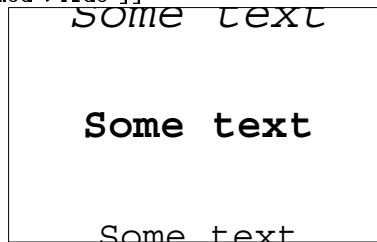
```
FontForm[expr, "fontname", size]
```

request a particular font and size for the printed form of *expr*

Specifying fonts and sizes of output.

This shows text in different fonts and sizes in graphics output.

```
In[1]:= Show[Graphics[{
  Text[FontForm["Some text", "Plain", 14], {0.5, 0.2}] ,
  Text[FontForm["Some text", "Bold", 16], {0.5, 0.4}] ,
  Text[FontForm["Some text", "Italic", 18], {0.5,
0.6}] },
Framed->True ]]
```



One of the great complications in specifying styles for text output is that not all output devices have the same set of fonts and sizes available. As a result, the external program that actually produces output has to map the font name and size you give into ones that are available.

The “size” you specify in **FontForm** gives the basic height of characters in units of “points”. One point is approximately $\frac{1}{72}$ inches. The main text in this book, for example, is set in 11 point type.